CLASS 7 ENGLISH — READING SKILL PAPER SET 08

Reading Comprehension | RBSE Board Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 45 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 20**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Section A has one factual passage with 10 questions (1 mark each).
3. Section B has one story or poem with 10 questions (1 mark each).
4. Write the question number before each answer.

SECTION — A (Reading Comprehension: Factual Passage) 10 Marks

Read the passage and answer the questions.

1. *Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.* 10

The Story of the Book

Long before paper was invented, people wrote on stones, clay tablets, palm leaves and bark. In India, scholars wrote on palm leaves and the inner bark of the birch tree, which were tied together with string. The Chinese invented paper nearly two thousand years ago, and the art of making it slowly spread across Asia to Europe.

For centuries, every book had to be copied by hand. A single copy could take months, and so books were rare and costly. Only kings, priests and rich people could afford them. This changed in the fifteenth century, when a German named Johannes Gutenberg built a printing machine that used movable metal letters. Many copies of a book could now be made in a short time, and the price of books fell sharply.

Today we can read a book on paper or on a screen, and an entire library can fit into a phone. But the purpose of a book has not changed: it carries ideas from one mind to another across space and time. A book written hundreds of years ago can still make a reader laugh or think today. That is the real magic of books.

(i) Before paper, Indian scholars wrote on: 1

(a) palm leaves and birch bark **(b)** wooden boards only
(c) glass **(d)** cloth only

(ii) Paper was first invented by the: 1

(a) Greeks **(b)** Chinese **(c)** Romans **(d)** Egyptians

(iii) Books were costly in the past because: 1

(a) they were small **(b)** each was copied by hand
(c) paper was free **(d)** there were many readers

(iv) State whether True or False: Gutenberg's machine used movable metal letters. 1

(a) True **(b)** False

(v) The last paragraph says that the purpose of a book is to: 1

(a) make money **(b)** decorate a shelf
(c) replace phones **(d)** carry ideas from one mind to another

(vi) Why could only rich people afford books earlier? 1

(vii) What was the effect of Gutenberg's printing machine? 1

(viii) Name two materials on which people wrote before paper. 1

(ix) Find a word in the passage that means 'not common; seldom found'. 1

(x) What does the writer call 'the real magic of books'? 1

SECTION — B (Reading Comprehension: Story / Poem) — 10 Marks

Read the text and answer the questions.

2. *Read the poem and answer the questions that follow.* — 10

Morning Market

Before the sun has climbed the wall
The market is awake;
The vegetable sellers call
And scales begin to shake.

There are tomatoes, round and red,
Green peas in a heap,
Ripe mangoes piled upon a cart,
And onions in a sweep.

The flower-seller threads the buds
Into a golden chain;
The air smells sweet of jasmine
And of the morning rain.

Then slowly down the dusty street
The buyers make their way,
And the market sings its busy song
Until the end of day.

(i) When does the market wake up? — 1

(a) Before sunrise gets high **(b)** In the afternoon
(c) At night **(d)** At midnight

(ii) The vegetable sellers: — 1

(a) call out to the buyers **(b)** sleep
(c) close shops **(d)** sing songs

(iii) The flower-seller makes: — 1

(a) a golden chain of buds **(b)** a paper kite
(c) a basket **(d)** a drum

(iv) State whether True or False: The air smells of jasmine and morning rain. — 1

(a) True **(b)** False

(v) The mood of the poem is: — 1

(a) lively and cheerful **(b)** sad
(c) silent **(d)** angry

(vi) Name two things sold in the market. — 1

(vii) What does the phrase 'scales begin to shake' suggest? — 1

(viii) Pick out a pair of rhyming words from the third stanza. — 1

(ix) What does the poet mean by 'the market sings its busy song'? — 1

(x) Which senses does the poet appeal to in the poem? Mention any two. — 1

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 20 Marks